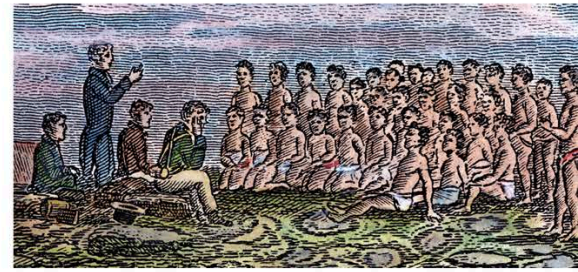




▲ TREATY OF WAITANGI

In 1840, about 540 Māori Rangatira (chiefs) signed the Treaty of Waitangi with Britain. The treaty gave Britain the right to buy Māori lands in exchange for defending them from attacks by other colonizing powers. However, arguments over the treaty's exact meaning led to future conflicts, and settlers at times ignored its terms to claim new lands.

Large gold nugget discovered in Victoria in 1853

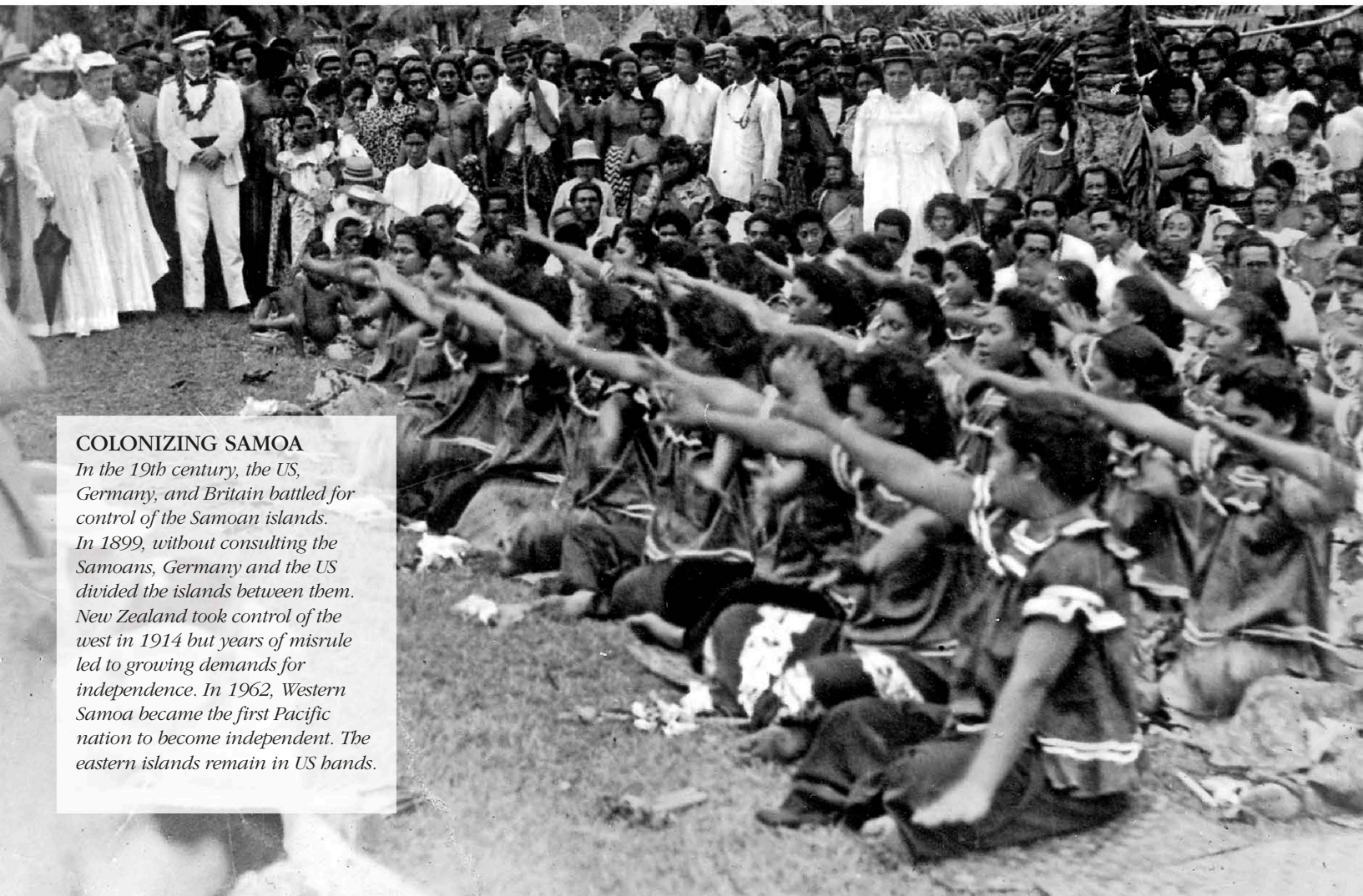


▲ SPREAD OF CHRISTIANITY

From the 17th century onward, European missionaries traveled to the Pacific islands to convert the Indigenous peoples of these islands to Christianity. Conversion gathered pace during the colonization of these territories by European countries. To this day, Christianity is the main religion on many of the islands.

◀ GOLD RUSH

In 1851, coal miners in the Australian colonies (now states) of New South Wales and Victoria found gold. The following year, prospectors arrived from Europe, the US, and China in the hope of making a fortune. Within twenty years, the Australian population had grown threefold to 1.7 million.



COLONIZING SAMOA

In the 19th century, the US, Germany, and Britain battled for control of the Samoan islands. In 1899, without consulting the Samoans, Germany and the US divided the islands between them. New Zealand took control of the west in 1914 but years of misrule led to growing demands for independence. In 1962, Western Samoa became the first Pacific nation to become independent. The eastern islands remain in US hands.